INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #9 · PARENTING

"I'm turning into my own parents."

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Where it often comes from

Many of us hear our parent's words come out of our own mouths and feel a chill. If we grew up with anger, coldness, addiction, or control, we may fear that we are destined to repeat it. The fear can be so strong that it makes us anxious, hypervigilant, or afraid to be close to our children.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" God promises, "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh." The fruit of the Spirit is "love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control." Paul also says, "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength." Patterns can pass down, but they are not destiny. Noticing the pattern is the first step in breaking it.

> *"Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"* (2 Corinthians 5:17).

Also see

> "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh" (Ezekiel 36:26).

> "But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law" (Galatians 5:22–23).

> "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:13).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

Common self-statements

- I am becoming exactly what I swore I would not.
- It is in my blood.
- I cannot help it.
- My children will end up like me.
- I never had a good model.
- I will repeat the same cycle.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will repeat the past.
- Labeling: Calling myself "just like them."
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either totally different or the same.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that it is inevitable.

Challenging questions

- In what specific ways do I notice I am like my parent, and in what ways am I different?

- What good qualities did I also receive from them?
- What triggers my reactions, and what can I do differently in that moment?
- What does Scripture say about a new heart?
- Who can help me learn new ways to parent?
- What small change can I make today?

Truth summary

> I am not doomed to repeat my parents' patterns. In Christ I am a new creation, and God gives me a new heart and His Spirit. I can notice old reactions, pause, repair, and practice new ones.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Parenting
- Anger
- Born Again
- Sinful Nature
- Holy Spirit

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Parenting
- Anger

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Chain Breaker — Zach Williams
Christ offers rescue and freedom to people who feel trapped by their past.

Amazing Grace My Chains Are Gone — Chris Tomlin
Salvation and freedom come through grace rather than earning acceptance.

Amazing Grace — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn locates salvation and sustaining hope in grace rather than merit.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm turning into my own parents"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm turning into my own parents." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How am I like my parent?
- ☐ How am I different?
- ☐ What triggers me?
- ☐ What will I do in the moment?
- ☐ Who can help me learn?
- ☐ What is one change today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ God gives me a new heart.
- ☐ The Spirit produces patience and gentleness in me.
- ☐ Patterns can be broken.
- ☐ Noticing is the first step.
- ☐ I can learn new ways.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"
- ☐ Ezekiel 36:26
  "I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you; I will remove your heart of stone and give you a heart of flesh."
- ☐ Galatians 5:22–23
  "But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Old pattern, new response: Each week, write one moment you noticed an old reaction and how you responded differently or repaired.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 2 Corinthians 5:17 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a new creation in Christ, not a copy of my parents.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anger" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List differences. Write ways your parenting is already different from theirs.
- ☐ Plan a pause. Decide on a phrase or action to use when you are triggered.
- ☐ Learn a skill. Read a book, take a class, or see a counselor on parenting.
- ☐ Repair quickly. When you slip, apologize and try again.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm turning into my own parents": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A new response
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm turning into my own parents.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear repeating what I grew up with. Make me new. Give me a heart that is gentle and patient, and teach me ways of loving my children that I never saw. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.